

# INCIDENT RESPONSE PLAYBOOK

## Malware Infection

*MITRE ATT&CK v14 | NIST SP 800-61r2 | With Decision Tree*

|                |                                     |
|----------------|-------------------------------------|
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| Version        | 1.0 — Initial Release               |
| Author         | BlueShield Team                     |
| Date           | June 2026                           |
| Framework      | MITRE ATT&CK v14 + NIST SP 800-61r2 |
| Incident Type  | Malware Infection                   |

# 1. Playbook Overview

## 1.1 Purpose

This playbook provides a structured, step-by-step guide for detecting, containing, eradicating, and recovering from Malware Infection incidents. It is designed for SOC Analysts, Incident Responders, and IT Security teams working within environments monitored by SIEM platforms such as SIEM.

## 1.2 Malware Definition

**Malware** is malicious software designed to harm, disrupt, or gain unauthorized access to computers, servers, or networks. It includes viruses, worms, trojans, ransomware, spyware, rootkits, botnets, keyloggers, cryptominers, and other malicious code. Malware is often used in cyberattacks to steal data, disrupt operations, maintain persistence, or evade detection within targeted systems.

## 1.3 Scope

- Endpoints: Workstations, Servers, Laptops
- Network segments visible to SIEM
- Malware types: Trojans, Worms, Spyware, Ransomware-droppers, RATs, Backdoors
- Excludes: Full Ransomware encryption events (separate playbook)

## 1.4 Severity Classification

| Severity | Criteria                                       | Response SLA         | Escalation      |
|----------|------------------------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------|
| Critical | Active C2, lateral movement, data exfiltration | Immediate (< 15 min) | L3 + Management |
| High     | Confirmed infection, no spread detected        | < 1 hour             | L2/L3           |
| Medium   | Suspicious indicators, unconfirmed infection   | < 4 hours            | L2              |
| Low      | Potentially unwanted software (PUP)            | < 24 hours           | L1              |

## 2. Roles & Responsibilities

| Role                    | Responsibility                                                          |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SOC Analyst (L1)        | First responder: triage alerts, initial investigation, log collection   |
| SOC Lead / L2 Analyst   | Deep investigation, malware analysis, threat correlation, MITRE mapping |
| Incident Commander (L3) | Oversees response, authorizes containment, manages escalation           |
| IT / Sysadmin Team      | Executes isolation, patch deployment, system reimaging                  |
| Threat Intelligence     | Identifies malware family, IOCs, TTPs from threat feeds                 |
| Management / CISO       | Business decisions, external communications, legal considerations       |

## 3. Incident Response Phases

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This playbook follows the NIST SP 800-61r2 Incident Response Lifecycle adapted for Malware Infection scenarios.

### 1 PREPARATION

#### Phase Objective

Establish the people, processes, and technologies required to effectively detect, respond to, and recover from malware incidents while minimizing business impact.

#### Preparation Activities

##### Security Controls & Monitoring

- Ensure Anti-Malware and EDR solutions are deployed, updated, and monitored.
- Enable centralized logging and SIEM monitoring across critical systems.
- Configure detection rules for malware execution, persistence, C2 activity, lateral movement, and data exfiltration.
- Maintain secure backups and an up-to-date asset inventory.

##### Incident Response Readiness

- Maintain and regularly review incident response procedures and escalation paths.
- Define roles, responsibilities, and communication channels.
- Ensure access to critical documentation and forensic tools.
- Establish evidence preservation and chain-of-custody procedures.

##### Threat Intelligence

- Monitor threat intelligence feeds and security advisories.
- Maintain IOC repositories and update detection content.
- Incorporate lessons learned from previous incidents.

##### Security Awareness & Training

- Conduct regular security awareness training and phishing simulations.
- Perform tabletop exercises to validate incident response readiness.

##### Key Deliverables

- Active Security Monitoring
- Updated Incident Response Procedures
- Defined Escalation Process
- Current Threat Intelligence Sources
- Trained Personnel
- Tested Backup and Recovery Capabilities

## 2 Detection

### Phase Objective

The objective of this phase is to detect, validate, and classify malware-related incidents, determine the scope and impact of the infection, and initiate the appropriate incident response process.

### Detection Activities

- Monitor security alerts from SIEM, EDR, Anti-Malware, IDS/IPS, and user reports.
- Validate alerts to determine whether malicious activity is present.
- Create or update an incident ticket and document all findings.
- Classify the incident severity based on affected assets, business impact, and infection scope.
- Escalate confirmed or suspected malware incidents according to the Incident Response Plan.

### Initial Investigation

- Identify affected hosts, users, accounts, and applications.
- Determine the malware infection vector (email, web download, removable media, exploit, etc.).
- Assess the scope of the compromise and identify any signs of propagation.
- Review endpoint, network, authentication, and security logs for related activity.
- Collect and preserve relevant evidence, including:
  - File hashes
  - Malicious files
  - Process information
  - Network connections
  - System and security logs
- Correlate findings with threat intelligence sources and known IOCs.
- Determine whether additional systems may be affected.

### Incident Assessment

- Confirm the malware type and attack characteristics where possible.
- Evaluate potential impacts to confidentiality, integrity, and availability.
- Assess indicators of:
  - Persistence
  - Command-and-Control (C2) communication
  - Privilege escalation
  - Lateral movement
  - Data exfiltration
- Reassess incident severity and update response actions accordingly.

## Escalation Criteria

Immediately escalate the incident if any of the following are identified:

- Active malware spreading across multiple systems.
- Confirmed Command-and-Control (C2) activity.
- Privileged account compromise.
- Critical server or business system affected.
- Evidence of data theft or exfiltration.
- Ransomware or malware dropper activity.

## Key Deliverables

- Incident Ticket Created
- Initial Scope Assessment
- Evidence Preserved
- Malware Classification
- Severity Determination
- Escalation Decision
- IOC Collection

## 3 Analysis

### Phase Objective

The objective of this phase is to determine the scope, impact, and root cause of the malware incident, identify affected assets, and develop an effective containment and remediation strategy.

### Analysis Activities

#### Malware Analysis

- Identify the malware family, type, and capabilities using threat intelligence platforms, sandbox analysis, and security tools.
- Validate Indicators of Compromise (IOCs) including file hashes, IP addresses, domains, URLs, and registry artifacts.
- Determine malware persistence mechanisms and execution methods.

#### Scope Assessment

- Establish a timeline of malicious activity and key events.
- Identify affected systems, users, accounts, and applications.
- Assess whether the malware has spread to additional hosts.
- Determine the initial infection vector and attack path.

## Impact Analysis

- Evaluate potential impacts to confidentiality, integrity, and availability.
- Identify evidence of:
  - Persistence
  - Privilege Escalation
  - Lateral Movement
  - Command-and-Control (C2) Communication
  - Data Exfiltration
- Assess potential business and operational impact.

## Threat Intelligence & Forensics

- Correlate findings with threat intelligence sources and known malware campaigns.
- Preserve relevant evidence for forensic investigation and legal requirements.
- Determine whether a full forensic investigation is required based on incident severity and business impact.

## Remediation Planning

- Verify that affected assets remain isolated.
- Identify containment and eradication requirements.
- Develop a remediation plan based on the scope and findings of the investigation.

## Key Deliverables

- Malware Classification
- Incident Timeline
- Scope Assessment
- Impact Assessment
- IOC Validation
- Forensic Investigation Decision
- Remediation Plan

## 4 Remediation (Containment, Eradication & Recovery)

### Phase Objective

The objective of this phase is to contain the malware infection, eradicate malicious artifacts from the environment, and safely restore affected systems and services to normal business operations.

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#### Containment

- Isolate infected or suspected systems from the network.
- Identify and monitor additional potentially affected assets.
- Block malicious IP addresses, domains, URLs, and Command-and-Control (C2) communications.
- Disable or restrict compromised accounts and enforce password resets and MFA where applicable.
- Preserve critical evidence, including malware samples, logs, and forensic artifacts.
- Communicate containment status to relevant stakeholders.

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#### Eradication

- Remove malware using approved security tools and remediation procedures.
- Eliminate persistence mechanisms, malicious services, scheduled tasks, registry modifications, and unauthorized accounts.
- Reimage systems when integrity cannot be verified.
- Apply security patches and remediate exploited vulnerabilities.
- Reset credentials associated with affected systems and users.
- Validate that all Indicators of Compromise (IOCs) have been removed.

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#### Recovery

- Restore affected systems and data from trusted backups where required.
- Reconnect remediated systems to the production environment.
- Restore business services based on operational priority and business impact.
- Perform full malware and security validation scans before returning systems to service.
- Monitor systems closely for signs of reinfection or suspicious activity.
- Confirm normal business operations have been restored.

#### Key Deliverables

- Malware Contained
- Malicious Artifacts Removed
- Compromised Accounts Remediated
- Systems Restored
- Services Returned to Operation
- Enhanced Monitoring Enable



## 5 Post-Incident Activities

### Phase Objective

The objective of this phase is to document the incident, identify lessons learned, improve security controls, and implement corrective actions to reduce the likelihood and impact of future malware incidents.

### Post-Incident Activities

#### Incident Reporting

- Prepare a final incident report detailing:
  - Incident timeline
  - Root cause
  - Scope and impact
  - Containment and remediation actions
  - Recovery activities
  - Recommendations for improvement
- Submit the report to relevant stakeholders and management.

#### Lessons Learned & Continuous Improvement

- Conduct a post-incident review meeting with all relevant teams.
- Identify gaps in people, processes, and technology.
- Document lessons learned and track improvement actions.
- Update detection rules, response procedures, and playbooks based on findings.
- Perform root cause analysis and remediate underlying weaknesses.

#### Security Enhancements

- Review and improve monitoring, alerting, and incident response capabilities.
- Update threat intelligence, IOC repositories, and security controls.
- Implement additional safeguards where required to prevent recurrence.

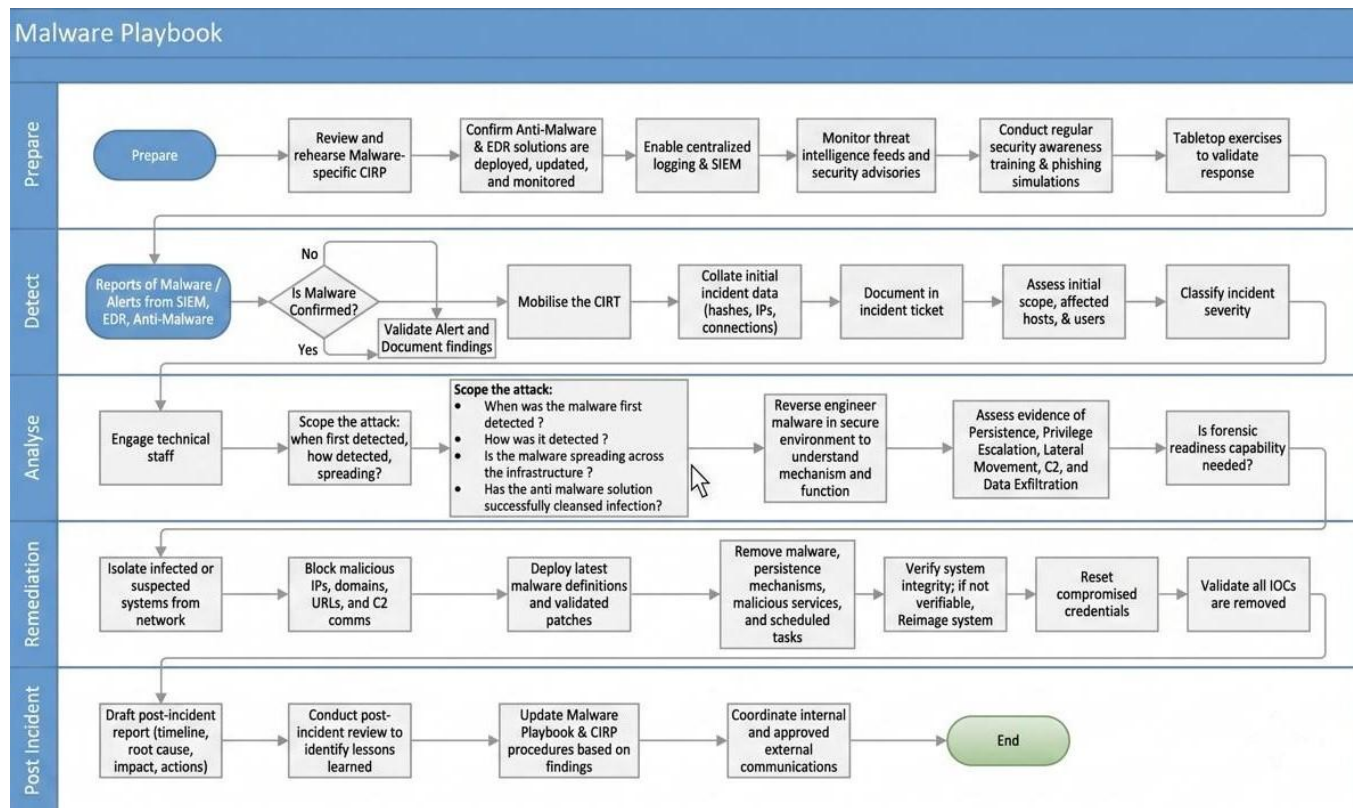
#### Communications & Compliance

- Provide internal communications and awareness updates where appropriate.
- Fulfill regulatory, legal, or contractual reporting requirements if applicable.
- Coordinate approved external communications through designated management and communications teams.

#### Key Deliverables

- Final Incident Report
- Root Cause Analysis
- Lessons Learned Report
- Updated Detection Rules
- Updated Playbook & Procedures
- Corrective Action Plan

## 4. Flow Diagram



## 5. Analyst Decision Tree

Use this decision tree when an alert fires. Follow each question top-to-bottom to determine the correct response action.

| # | Question / Condition                                                    | YES → Action                                                  | NO → Action                                   |
|---|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Is the alert from a known-good (whitelisted) source?                    | Close as False Positive. Document reason.                     | Proceed to Q2                                 |
| 2 | Is there matching IOC (hash/IP/domain) in Threat Intel feeds?           | Escalate to L2. Open High severity ticket.                    | Proceed to Q3                                 |
| 3 | Is there evidence of process injection or unusual parent-child process? | Confirm infection. Isolate host immediately.                  | Proceed to Q4                                 |
| 4 | Is there outbound network traffic to suspicious IPs/domains?            | Confirm C2 activity. Block at Firewall. Escalate to Critical. | Proceed to Q5                                 |
| 5 | Are there persistence mechanisms (registry/scheduled tasks/services)?   | Confirmed persistent infection. Begin Eradication phase.      | Proceed to Q6                                 |
| 6 | Is there evidence of lateral movement (logons to other hosts)?          | Escalate to Critical. Isolate network segment. Notify L3.     | Assign Medium. Deep investigation required.   |
| 7 | Is there evidence of data exfiltration (large outbound transfers)?      | Escalate to Critical. Preserve evidence. Notify CISO + Legal. | Proceed with standard Eradication + Recovery. |

### Response Level Summary:

| Condition Met                       | Severity      | Owner           | SLA           |
|-------------------------------------|---------------|-----------------|---------------|
| IOC match + C2 + Lateral Movement   | Critical      | L3 + Management | Immediate     |
| IOC match + Persistence (no C2)     | High          | L2/L3           | < 1 hour      |
| Suspicious indicators, no IOC match | Medium        | L2              | < 4 hours     |
| False positive confirmed            | Informational | L1              | Document only |

## 6. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

The following tables map common Malware Infection behaviors to the MITRE ATT&CK Enterprise framework (v14).

### 6.1 Initial Access

| Tactic         | Technique                 | ID        | Description                                                                | Detection in SIEM                                                    |
|----------------|---------------------------|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Initial Access | Spearphishing Attachment  | T1566.001 | Malware via malicious email attachment (macro-enabled Office, PDF exploit) | Email gateway alerts, Office spawning cmd.exe/powershell.exe exploit |
| Initial Access | Drive-by Compromise       | T1189     | User visits compromised website, browser exploit delivers payload          | Unusual browser child processes, new files in %TEMP%/%%APPDATA%      |
| Initial Access | Valid Accounts            | T1078     | Attacker uses stolen credentials to authenticate and deploy malware        | Logins from unusual geo/time, auth failures then success             |
| Initial Access | Exploit Public-Facing App | T1190     | Malware via exploitation of unpatched internet-facing application          | IDS/IPS alerts, unusual app behavior, error spikes                   |

### 6.2 Execution

| Tactic    | Technique                      | ID        | Description                                                               | Detection in SIEM                                                         |
|-----------|--------------------------------|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Execution | PowerShell                     | T1059.001 | Malware uses PowerShell to download/execute payloads, often encoded       | PowerShell encoded commands, ScriptBlock logging, execution policy bypass |
| Execution | Windows Command Shell          | T1059.003 | cmd.exe used to run malicious scripts, copy payloads, spawn processes     | cmd.exe spawned by Office/Browser, suspicious command strings             |
| Execution | WMI                            | T1047     | WMI used to execute code and maintain persistence via event subscriptions | WMI activity logs, new EventFilter/EventConsumer subscriptions            |
| Execution | User Execution: Malicious File | T1204.002 | User double-clicks malicious attachment, directly executing malware       | New process from Downloads/Temp, email attachment opens                   |

## 6.3 Persistence

| Tactic      | Technique                    | ID        | Description                                                       | Detection in SIEM                                                           |
|-------------|------------------------------|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Persistence | Registry Run Keys            | T1547.001 | Malware adds itself to HKLM/HKCU Run keys or Startup folder       | Sysmon Event 13 (registry mod), new Run key entries from non-standard paths |
| Persistence | Scheduled Task               | T1053.005 | Malware creates scheduled tasks to re-execute at intervals        | Sysmon Event 1 (schtasks.exe), new tasks in non-standard locations          |
| Persistence | Create/Modify System Process | T1543.003 | Malware installs as Windows Service to run with system privileges | New service events (Event ID 7045), services from unusual paths             |

## 6.4 Defense Evasion

| Tactic          | Technique              | ID        | Description                                                              | Detection in SIEM                                                           |
|-----------------|------------------------|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Defense Evasion | Masquerading           | T1036     | Malware names itself after legitimate processes (svchost.exe, lsass.exe) | Process running from non-standard path, parent-child anomalies              |
| Defense Evasion | Obfuscated Files       | T1027     | Payloads encoded in Base64/XOR or packed to evade AV signatures          | High entropy file writes, encoded PowerShell, AMSI bypass attempts          |
| Defense Evasion | Disable Security Tools | T1562.001 | Malware disables Defender, Firewall, event logging to hinder detection   | Security service stopped, Event ID 1102 (log cleared), audit policy changes |
| Defense Evasion | Process Injection      | T1055     | Malware injects code into legitimate processes (explorer.exe, lsass.exe) | Sysmon Event 8 (CreateRemoteThread), unusual memory writes                  |

## 6.5 Command & Control

| Tactic | Technique              | ID        | Description                                                                     | Detection in SIEM                                                                 |
|--------|------------------------|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| C2     | Application Layer: Web | T1071.001 | Malware uses HTTP/HTTPS to blend C2 with normal web traffic                     | <i>Beaconing patterns, HTTP to non-categorized domains, new DNS queries</i>       |
| C2     | DNS Tunneling          | T1071.004 | Malware encodes data in DNS queries/responses to exfiltrate or receive commands | <i>High-volume DNS queries, unusually long query strings, uncommon TLDs</i>       |
| C2     | Encrypted Channel      | T1573     | Malware uses encrypted communication to hide C2 traffic                         | <i>Certificate anomalies (self-signed/expired), unexpected encrypted patterns</i> |

## 7. MITRE ATT&CK Coverage Heatmap

This heatmap visualizes detection coverage for each mapped technique. Use it to identify gaps in your SIEM rules and detection capabilities.

Legend:

HIGH Coverage

MEDIUM  
Coverage

LOW Coverage

| Technique             | SIEM Alert | Log Source | EDR Rule | Network Block | Coverage |
|-----------------------|------------|------------|----------|---------------|----------|
| T1566 Spearphishing   | HIGH       | HIGH       | MED      | —             | HIGH     |
| T1189 Drive-by        | MED        | MED        | LOW      | MED           | MED      |
| T1059 PowerShell      | HIGH       | HIGH       | HIGH     | —             | HIGH     |
| T1047 WMI             | MED        | MED        | MED      | —             | MED      |
| T1547 Registry Run    | HIGH       | HIGH       | HIGH     | —             | HIGH     |
| T1053 Sched. Task     | HIGH       | HIGH       | MED      | —             | HIGH     |
| T1036 Masquerading    | MED        | MED        | HIGH     | —             | MED      |
| T1055 Proc. Injection | MED        | MED        | HIGH     | —             | MED      |
| T1562 Disable Tools   | HIGH       | HIGH       | MED      | —             | HIGH     |
| T1071 C2 HTTP/DNS     | HIGH       | HIGH       | —        | HIGH          | HIGH     |
| T1573 Encrypted C2    | LOW        | MED        | —        | MED           | LOW      |
| T1078 Valid Accounts  | MED        | HIGH       | —        | —             | MED      |

Gap Analysis: Encrypted C2 (T1573) and Drive-by (T1189) show LOW EDR coverage — prioritize rule development for these techniques in the next SIEM tuning cycle.

## 8. Malware Type Quick-Reference Cheat Sheet

Use this reference during Identification phase to quickly profile the malware type based on observed behavior.

| Type                       | Examples                                      | How It Spreads                                                 | Key Indicators                                                                                | First Response                                                                         |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Trojan                     | Emotet, TrickBot, AgentTesla                  | Email attachment, malicious download, fake software            | Unexpected network connections, keylogger activity, data staging in %TEMP%                    | Isolate host, capture RAM, block C2 IPs                                                |
| Worm                       | WannaCry (pre-ransom), Conficker              | Network shares (SMB), removable drives, email self-replication | High network traffic, SMB errors, multiple hosts infected simultaneously                      | Isolate entire VLAN, disable SMB if needed, patch MS17-010                             |
| RAT (Remote Access Trojan) | DarkComet, NjRAT, AsyncRAT                    | Phishing, pirated software, drive-by downloads                 | Persistent outbound connections, webcam/mic activation, remote shell activity                 | Block C2, disable user account, full forensic analysis                                 |
| Spyware                    | Pegasus (mobile), RedLine Stealer             | Malicious ads, bundled with freeware, phishing links           | Browser credential theft, clipboard monitoring, keylogging, crypto wallet theft               | Collect evidence first, reset all credentials, notify affected users                   |
| Ransomware Dropper         | Emotet dropping Ryuk, TrickBot dropping Conti | Phishing, RDP brute force, supply chain                        | Dropper stage: PowerShell downloads, reconnaissance commands run before encryption            | Stop immediately — do NOT wait for encryption to start. Isolate + escalate to Critical |
| Fileless Malware           | PowerShell Empire, Cobalt Strike              | Office macro, memory injection, LOLBins                        | No files on disk, lives in memory/registry, uses legitimate tools (PowerShell, WMI, certutil) | RAM capture essential. Sysmon + PowerShell logging critical for detection              |
| Rootkit                    | ZeroAccess, Necurs                            | Trojan dropper, bootkit, kernel exploit                        | Hidden processes, disabled AV, BSOD on AV scan, boot-time persistence                         | May require offline analysis or OS reinstall — do NOT trust the OS after rootkit       |



## 9. IOC Collection Checklist

| IOC Category | Examples                                                     | Collection Method                        |
|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| File-Based   | MD5/SHA256 hashes, file names, paths, sizes                  | FTK Imager, PowerShell Get-FileHash, EDR |
| Network      | C2 IPs, malicious domains, ports, contacted URLs             | SIEM, Firewall logs, Wireshark           |
| Host-Based   | Registry keys, scheduled tasks, new services, mutexes        | Sysmon logs, RegShot, Autoruns           |
| Memory       | Injected code, suspicious DLLs, network sockets              | Volatility, Rekall, RAM dump analysis    |
| Log-Based    | Event IDs: 4688,4624/25,7045,1102,4698   Sysmon: 1,3,8,11,13 | Windows Event Viewer, SIEM               |
| Email        | Sender address, attachment hash, subject, headers            | Email gateway, header analysis tools     |

## 10. Escalation Matrix

| Scenario                            | Escalate To             | Method           | Timeframe    |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------|------------------|--------------|
| Active C2 confirmed                 | Incident Commander (L3) | Phone + Ticket   | Immediately  |
| Malware spreading to multiple hosts | SOC Lead + L3           | Phone + Ticket   | < 15 minutes |
| Data exfiltration confirmed         | L3 + CISO + Legal       | Phone + Email    | Immediately  |
| Critical server infected            | L2 + IT Manager         | Phone + Ticket   | < 30 minutes |
| Ransomware dropper identified       | L3 + Management         | Phone + War Room | Immediately  |
| Incident unresolved > 4 hours       | L3 + CISO               | Status Meeting   | < 4 hours    |

## 11. Tools Reference

| Tool                   | Phase                       | Purpose                                                          | Notes                                                          |
|------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| SIEM                   | All phases                  | Central log aggregation, correlation, alerting                   | Primary SIEM                                                   |
| Firewall               | Containment                 | Network isolation, IP/domain blocking, VLAN quarantine           | IPS + App Control enabled                                      |
| Sysinternals Suite     | Identification, Eradication | Process Explorer, Autoruns, TCPView, ProcMon                     | Free — Microsoft                                               |
| Volatility 3           | Identification              | Memory forensics — processes, network connections, injected code | Open Source — Python                                           |
| VirusTotal / Any.run   | Identification              | Submit file hashes or live sandbox malware analysis              | Web-based                                                      |
| Sysmon                 | Identification              | Enhanced Windows event logging — process, network, registry      | Use SwiftOnSecurity config                                     |
| MITRE ATT&CK Navigator | All phases                  | Map TTPs, visualize coverage gaps, track attack progression      | Free — <a href="https://attack.mitre.org">attack.mitre.org</a> |

## 12. References & Further Reading

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### 12.1 Standards & Frameworks

- NIST SP 800-61 Rev. 2 — Computer Security Incident Handling Guide
  - <https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/SpecialPublications/NIST.SP.800-61r2.pdf>
- MITRE ATT&CK Enterprise Matrix v14
  - <https://attack.mitre.org/matrices/enterprise/>
- SANS Incident Handler's Handbook
  - <https://www.sans.org/white-papers/33901/>
- CISA Incident Response Guidance
  - [https://www.cisa.gov/sites/default/files/publications/NCCIC\\_ICS-CERT\\_AAL\\_Incident\\_Response.pdf](https://www.cisa.gov/sites/default/files/publications/NCCIC_ICS-CERT_AAL_Incident_Response.pdf)

### 12.2 Tools Documentation

- FortiSIEM 7.2 Admin Guide — <https://docs.fortinet.com/fortisiem>
- Volatility 3 Documentation — <https://volatility3.readthedocs.io>
- Sysmon Configuration (SwiftOnSecurity) — <https://github.com/SwiftOnSecurity/sysmon-config>
- MITRE ATT&CK Navigator — <https://mitre-attack.github.io/attack-navigator/>
- Any.run Sandbox — <https://any.run/>
- AlienVault OTX Threat Intelligence — <https://otx.alienvault.com/>

### 12.3 Malware Intelligence Resources

- MalwareBazaar (Abuse.ch) — <https://bazaar.abuse.ch/>
- VirusTotal Intelligence — <https://virustotal.com/>
- Hybrid Analysis — <https://hybrid-analysis.com/>
- Malpedia Malware Encyclopedia — <https://malpedia.caad.fkie.fraunhofer.de/>

## 13. Appendix — Incident Report Template

| Field                  | Value                                            |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Incident ID            | IR-YYYY-XXX                                      |
| Incident Title         | Malware Infection — [System/User Name]           |
| Severity               | Critical / High / Medium / Low                   |
| Date/Time Detected     | YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM (UTC)                           |
| Date/Time Resolved     | YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM (UTC)                           |
| Affected Systems       | List of hostnames / IPs                          |
| Malware Family / Type  | e.g., Emotet, AsyncRAT, Fileless                 |
| Initial Vector         | Email / Web / USB / RDP / Other                  |
| MITRE Tactics Observed | e.g., Initial Access, Execution, Persistence, C2 |
| Containment Actions    | Description of actions taken                     |
| Eradication Actions    | Description of removal steps                     |
| Data Exfiltrated?      | Yes / No / Unknown — Details if Yes              |
| Root Cause             | Technical root cause summary                     |
| Recommendations        | Actions to prevent recurrence                    |
| Analyst Name           | Name / Contact                                   |
| Reviewed By            | Incident Commander / SOC Lead                    |